

Benjamin R. Westlund
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
Gillings School of Global Public Health
Department of Health Behavior
170 Rosenau Hall
Chapel Hill, NC, 27599
919-808-7196
benwestlund@med.unc.edu

Education

University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill - *PhD in Health Behavior, Expected 2029*

- Faculty Advisor: Vivian Go
- Dorothy Dunn Scholarship

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill - *MSPH in Health Behavior, May 2026*

- Concentration: Health Behavior
- Dorothy Dunn Scholarship

Wake Forest University - *B.A., Sociology, 2022*

- Major: Sociology, Social Determinants of Health and Well-being
- Minor Equivalent: Health and Exercise Science
- *Cum Laude*, Honors and Distinction in Sociology

Research & Academic Positions

- **Graduate Research Assistant**, Department of Health Behavior, UNC Gillings School of Global Public Health (Aug 2024–Present)

Projects include rural opioid harm-reduction research (OHOP), provider alcohol use in Vietnam, and emergency preparedness planning. Responsibilities include qualitative coding and analysis (NVivo), survey instrument development, theory-driven memo writing, and mixed-methods integration.

- **Research and Program Support Specialist**, North Carolina Formerly Incarcerated Transition Program (NC FIT), UNC Family Medicine (Aug 2022–Jul 2024)

Supported clinical reentry navigation for formerly incarcerated individuals through care coordination, data tracking, and Medicaid suspension/reactivation work. Contributed to program evaluation, qualitative interviews, communication with county stakeholders, and development of strategic partnerships.

- **Senior Honors Thesis Researcher**, Wake Forest University (Aug 2021–May 2022)

Designed and led an independent qualitative study on the intersection of COVID-19 and opioid use disorder. Conducted interviews, completed thematic analysis, and authored a grant-winning thesis.

- **Research Assistant**, Center for Health Policy and Inequalities Research (CHPIR) (May–Aug 2021)

Assisted with HRV intervention research, literature reviews, qualitative memo development, and data management.

Teaching Experience

- **Teaching Assistant**, Wake Forest University (Aug–Dec 2021)
TA for undergraduate sociology seminar. Supported course design, graded writing assignments, and led mini lectures.

Technical and Research Skills

- **Qualitative:** Thematic analysis, grounded theory, memo writing, codebook development, NVivo, Dedoose
- **Quantitative:** Stata, survey design, data management
- **Mixed Methods:** Joint displays, integration, hybrid designs
- **Implementation Science:** CFIR, ERIC, barrier/strategy matrices

Publications

Working Papers

- Westlund, B., et al. Emergency Preparedness Planning: Lessons from COVID-19 and the Opioid Crisis in Rural Ohio. Manuscript in preparation.
- Westlund, B., et al. A Socioecological Examination of Provider Alcohol Use in Vietnam. Manuscript in preparation.

Fellowships and Awards

- Dorothy Dunn Scholarship, UNC Gillings School of Global Public Health, 2024
- Faculty-Student Facilitation Fund Grant Award, Wake Forest University, 2022

Research Grants

- Westlund, B. & Brewer, A. (advisor). The Intersection of the Opioid Crisis and the COVID-19 Pandemic; Wake Forest University, Faculty-Student Facilitation Fund Grant Award, \$200, *funded*.

Memberships in Associations and Institutional Affiliations

- American Public Health Association (APHA) – Early Career Professional
- North Carolina Public Health Association